

How to raise a build contract with Claude

Give Claude the build contract request email and it fills in the contract documents for you, using Transpire's own templates off the **Z:** drive, not something it made up. It saves the finished documents into the job folder and hands you a review sheet. Nothing is ever sent, signed or issued without you.

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It uses the real template, every time. Claude opens the same blank document you would open from **Z:\PROCEDURES & FORMS\CONTRACTS** and types into it. The wording, the styles, the inclusions list and the page numbering are left exactly as they are. Only the fields change. It has been taught which template belongs to which region (Tamworth and Gunnedah jobs share one; Sydney and SEQ have their own), which folders are superseded, and which fields to fill, from the **Raising Contracts** section of the System and Procedures Manual. **It will never invent a contract format.** If it can't find the right template it stops and tells you.

Start here: five steps

1

Open **Claude Desktop** and sign in with your own account.

2

Switch to **Code** mode.

3

Pick the project folder **transpire-claude-code**.

4

Accept the folder-trust prompt. **Once only.**

5

Type **/new-contract-template** and point it at the request email.

The folder to pick in step 3 is **Z:\CLAUDE CODE\transpire-claude-code**. Browse to it once and Claude remembers it. Steps 1 to 4 are a one-off; after that you land straight on step 5 each time. For the email, either save it out of Outlook as a **.msg** file and give Claude the path, or just paste the subject line. It can find the message itself. **Start a new chat for each job** so it picks up the latest instructions.

Where the documents go: four rules

1. **It looks in the job folder first.** Before filling anything, Claude checks the job's **CONTRACT DOCUMENTATION** folder under **Z:\PROJECTS** and notes which contract documents are already there: inclusions, preliminary agreement, build contract.
2. **A document the job does not have yet is a real contract.** Its Word file and PDF are saved straight into that **CONTRACT DOCUMENTATION** folder. It never goes to the testing folder.
3. **A document the job already has is treated as a re-run.** The new copy goes only to the testing folder (**Z:\CLAUDE CODE\cowork-projects\3.new_contract\template-testing\<job>**). The original in the job folder is never overwritten. If the new one is right, you move the old one into the folder's **SS** subfolder and copy the new one across.
4. **The build contract is produced too, every time.** Until the manager files the approved Word contract in the templates folder, Claude fills from the team's own Word build and saves it under the real file name. The report tells you which template it used; a person reads the draft against the licensed HIA PDF before it is issued.

This is decided document by document. On a job that already has its inclusions but no build contract yet, one run puts the inclusions re-run in the testing folder and the build contract straight into the job folder. The run report prints a line per document saying where it went.

What happens when you run it

1 It reads the whole email chain, and the attachments

Including the EOI, when the file has readable text.

WHAT IT PULLS OUT

- The buyer's name, from the EOI, not from an email signature
- Design, façade and contract price
- Whether the EOI is marked dual key
- Anything the sales manager asked for: a review first, no prelim agreement, a changed price

Why this matters: these emails get forwarded two or three times. The instruction to you is in the newest part, the job facts are in the oldest part from the marketer. It reads all of it.

Scanned EOIs. If the EOI and ID are a scanned picture with no text, Claude cannot read them on this server and will ask you for the names. Type them exactly as they appear on the ID, including middle names, and check the spelling on the finished document yourself.

2 It finds the job folder and picks the template

And tells you both, before it fills anything in.

You get back: the job folder it found on **Z:** (it also checks the completed and cancelled folders, and warns you if a cancelled job sits at the same lot), the full path of the blank template it is about to use, and a line per document saying whether that document will go to the job folder or the testing folder. If the job folder does not exist yet, Claude asks you before creating it.

It knows what is out of date. Anything in an **SS** folder is superseded, and there are a lot of them. It also skips files marked "don't use" and any template named for a different marketer or estate. If two templates could both be right, it asks rather than guessing.

3 It fills the documents and saves them

Inclusions, the preliminary agreement if the job needs one, and the build contract.

THE FIELDS IT COMPLETES

- Inclusions: lot, street, suburb, estate, price, house type, house size, façade, garage side, client names, site address, Builders Representative
- Build contract: cover page (owners, job, lot, site), the owner block, the land details, the signature names and the checklist names
- Owner address, mobiles, emails, DP number and land address, when the request gives them

You get back: each document as a finished **.docx** and its PDF, saved per the four rules above, plus a list of exactly what changed against the blank template so you can see it touched the fields and nothing else.

Signatures, dates, initials and money are left empty. Always. Signing is yours and Michael's. Price excluding GST, GST, contract price, deposit and progress payments come from DataBuild and Claude never types them unless you give it the exact figures.

4 It tells you what it could not fill

This is the part worth reading properly.

TYPICAL FLAGS

- "Garage side isn't in the email or the plans, it needs confirming"
- "The plans haven't arrived, so house size is blank"
- "This job already has inclusions, so the new inclusions went to the testing folder; the build contract went into the job folder"
- "Owner names were typed in by you, not read from the ID. Check the spelling"
- "Dual key: the standard inclusions have no second-dwelling section. Someone needs to write it"

You get back: a short review sheet listing every field, where each value came from, every blank, and every flag. It also lists the values you still need to key in yourself (see the checks below).

Before anything is issued: your checks

1. **Read the build contract against the licensed HIA PDF once.** The Word template is the team's own build and is still waiting on the manager's formal sign-off, so this read-through is your safety check on layout and wording.
2. **Check the owner names and spelling against the ID.** If the EOI was a scan, the names came from what was typed into the chat.
3. **Key the money from DataBuild.** Contract price, GST, deposit and the progress payment schedule are never filled automatically.
4. **Fill what is still blank.** Owner address, every purchaser's mobile and email (DocuSign needs all of them), DP number, land address and any guarantor details stay empty until someone supplies them.
5. **Dual key and plans.** The auxiliary dwelling inclusions text has to be written by a person; house size and garage side wait for the plans; confirm the building period category.
6. **Check the report's route lines** so you know which documents are in the job folder and which are in the testing folder waiting to be moved across. Claude never issues, sends or signs anything.

Filling in the blanks afterwards

WHAT YOU HAVE	WHAT TO DO
Owner contacts, DP number, land address, guarantor, DataBuild figures	Tell Claude the values in the same chat and ask it to run the job again. Say them plainly: "Lot 142: owner mobile is ..., second owner email is ..., DP number is ..., price excluding GST is ...". Because the job folder already has the document, the new version lands in the testing folder (rule 3). Check it, move the old one into SS , copy the new one across.
Progress payment schedule, special conditions, auxiliary dwelling inclusions text, house size, garage side, building period	Edit the .docx in Word yourself. Claude will never write these. Type them in, then save a fresh PDF (File, Save As, PDF) so the Word file and the PDF stay together under the same names. Move the old pair into SS .
A wrong or misspelt owner name	Either way works: correct it in Word and re-save the PDF, or give Claude the exact name and re-run.
The PDF only	Never edit the PDF. It is only an export of the Word file. Change the Word file, then export again.

What it will never do

- **Never** invent contract wording, or a contract format. It fills the company's template or it stops.
- **Never** guess a number that goes in a contract. Price, house size, garage side and the prelim fee are either sourced or flagged for you.
- **Never** sign, initial or date anything, and never send an email or issue anything to DocuSign.
- **Never** overwrite a file that is already in a job folder. A document the job already has is re-run into the testing folder for you to check and move across; only documents the job does not have yet are saved straight in.

It still stops and asks when a real decision is needed: a price that doesn't match the EOI, two templates that could both fit, whether the job needs a preliminary agreement, or whether to create a job folder that does not exist yet.

What it produces, and what it doesn't

DOCUMENT	WHAT YOU GET
Inclusions	Filled in, ready to check. The real Word template with all the fields completed.
Preliminary agreement	Filled in , when the job needs one. Claude asks whether the job needs it. The standard fee is used unless the request names a different one.
Build contract	Filled in and saved into the job folder. Claude fills the cover page, the owner block, the land details and the signature names on the team's Word version of the licensed NSW or QLD contract, and exports the PDF (45 pages for NSW, 37 for QLD). The report names the template it used. Prices, GST, deposit and progress payments always stay yours; they come from DataBuild. Read it against the licensed HIA PDF before it is issued.
Plans, general conditions, colour options	Not produced. Listed as a checklist so nothing is forgotten from the pack.

Everything it hands you is a draft. Read it against the email, the ID and the plans before it goes anywhere. It is quick and it is careful, but it has not seen the site, spoken to the client, or opened DataBuild.

Getting a good draft

DO THIS	WHY IT HELPS
Include the EOI and the ID, as readable files if you can	The buyer's name comes off the EOI. A scanned picture cannot be read here, so you will be asked to type the names
Give the owner contacts and land details up front	Address, mobiles, emails, DP number and land address go straight onto the build contract instead of being blanks to fill later
Wait for the plans if you can	House size and garage side come off the plans and nowhere else
Say if it is a dual key or auxiliary dwelling	The standard inclusions do not cover the second dwelling. It flags this, but confirming saves a round trip
Give the job number if you have it	Lot numbers repeat across estates; job numbers do not
Read the flags before the document	The flags tell you whether the document is usable yet

If something goes wrong

PROBLEM	FIX
"I can't see the Z: drive"	The task is running in the cloud. Start again in Code mode on your computer.
It says the template has changed	Take this seriously. Somebody has revised the blank template, so Claude stopped rather than produce a half-filled contract. Tell the team; it needs a small update before it will run again.
The build contract went to the testing folder, not the job folder	The job folder already had a build contract, so this run was a re-run (rule 3). Check the new one, move the old pair into <code>SS</code> , and copy the new pair across.
Claude asked me for the owner names	The EOI or ID was a scanned picture with no text. Type the names exactly as on the ID and check the spelling on the finished document.
It left garage side blank	Working as intended. It is read off the site plan drawing and Claude will not guess it. Fill it in yourself, or ask Michael.
The build contract has no prices in it	Working as intended. Give Claude the DataBuild figures and re-run, or type them into the Word file yourself (see "Filling in the blanks").
It says a file is "open in another program"	You (or someone) have the old PDF open. Close it and tell Claude to re-run the delivery. Nothing needs re-typing.
It says the price on the email and the EOI disagree	It stops on purpose. Don't pick one; get it confirmed.
It won't change the inclusions for an auxiliary dwelling	Also on purpose. Which inclusions apply to a second dwelling is a pricing decision, so it goes to Michael rather than being written by Claude.
The job isn't where you expected	Finished and cancelled jobs move out of the live region folder. Claude checks those too; give it the job number.
I still see an old file named "TEST UNAPPROVED TEMPLATE"	That was the practice-copy name used before 8 September 2026. It is no longer produced; ignore old copies in the testing folder.

Transpire, build contract guide. Updated 8 September 2026. Questions, or something in here is wrong? Tell the team. This guide is maintained and gets updated as the templates and the procedure change. The field rules behind it are in the project repo under `job-roles/contract-admin/rules/contract-docs.md` , and the template map under `.claude/skills/new-contract-template/references/` .